Business Requirements Document (BRD)

CRM Lead & Sales Pipeline Management System | Self-initiated BA portfolio case study

1. Purpose

This document defines the business problem, objectives, stakeholders, scope, high-level requirements, assumptions, and open decisions for a proposed CRM Lead & Sales Pipeline Management System. The scenario and data are fictional and created for a BA portfolio.

2. Business problem

Lead information is spread across spreadsheets, email, and professional networking sources. Follow-ups are tracked manually, qualification decisions vary by sales executive, and managers lack a centralized view of pipeline progress and outcomes.

3. Objectives

- Centralize lead information and ownership.
- Standardize lead qualification and status definitions.
- Record contact and follow-up activity.
- Provide pipeline and outcome visibility to Sales Managers.
- Support analysis of lead sources, lead outcomes, and conversion rate.

4. Stakeholders

Stakeholder	Interest / responsibility
Sales Executive / BDE	Create and maintain leads; record interactions; qualify leads.
Sales Manager	Monitor pipeline, lead ownership, and outcomes.
Marketing	Understand lead-source performance.
Management	Review high-level business outcomes.
Business Analyst	Elicit, analyze, document, and validate requirements.
Development / QA	Design, build, and verify the proposed system.

5. AS-IS summary

Leads are stored in Excel with supporting information in emails or LinkedIn. Executives manually remember or record follow-ups. Qualification is judgment-based without a formal checklist. Status changes and sales progression are not governed by a fully documented process. Managers assemble views from fragmented information.

6. In scope

- Create and update lead records.
- Capture required lead information and assign an owner.
- Maintain lead status and qualification outcome.
- Record contact attempts and follow-up details.
- Provide manager-facing pipeline and outcome summaries.
- Maintain status-change and activity history.

7. Out of scope (initial version)

- Automated email/SMS/LinkedIn outreach.
- Integration with external marketing platforms.
- Revenue forecasting and complex quota compensation.
- Automated reminders until stakeholders approve the behavior.
- Production deployment or real customer data.

8. Business requirements

ID	Requirement	Description
BR-01	Centralized lead management	The system shall store lead information in a centralized record.
BR-02	Lead assignment	Each lead shall have an assigned sales executive.
BR-03	Lead classification	Users shall maintain an approved lead status.
BR-04	Qualification	Users shall qualify leads using agreed business criteria.
BR-05	Follow-up tracking	Users shall record contact attempts and planned follow-ups.
BR-06	Pipeline visibility	Sales Managers shall view lead and opportunity distribution.
BR-07	Outcome visibility	Managers shall review outcomes by source and owner.
BR-08	History	The system shall retain status-change and activity history.

9. Lead fields and mandatory rules

Field	Rule
Lead Name	Required
Company Name	Required
Email / Phone	At least one is required
Lead Source	Required; approved values
Assigned Executive	Required
Lead Status	Required; approved values
Other contact and activity fields	Optional or conditional as defined in data dictionary

10. Status definitions

Status	Definition
New	Created but not yet contacted.
Contacted	At least one contact attempt has been made.
Qualified	Meets agreed criteria and has potential as a business opportunity.
Converted	Results in confirmed business engagement/client.
Lost	No longer being pursued, with a reason captured where feasible.

11. Qualification criteria

A lead may be qualified when a genuine business requirement exists, the company can potentially address it, contact has been established, the prospect shows interest, and reasonable business potential exists. A formal checklist/scoring method remains a proposed refinement.

12. Assumptions and open questions

- Reminder functionality requires stakeholder approval.
- Confirm whether unqualified leads should be marked Lost or retained for nurture.
- Confirm duplicate detection and merge rules.
- Confirm whether status can move backwards and which roles may reassign leads.
- Confirm dashboard time filters, KPI definitions, and performance metrics.
- Confirm required lost reasons and follow-up outcome values.